

Lesson 2: Turn a Skill Into a Service

Course 17: Skills That Pay — Digital Independence Path

What This Lesson Is About

In Course 16, you built a portfolio. In Lesson 1 of this course, you learned how the freelance world works — the platforms, the client types, the basics of pricing.

Now it's time to answer a harder question: **what, exactly, would you offer someone?**

"I know coding" or "I'm good at design" is true, but it's not something a client can say yes to. Today you'll turn one skill you already have proof of into a **service** — a specific, describable thing someone could actually hire you for.

Why This Matters

Nobody hires "a person who knows HTML." They hire someone who can say: "I'll build you a 4-page website for your tutoring business by next Friday." That sentence is clear enough to trust. Vague skills don't get hired — clear services do.

This lesson is the bridge between "I can do things" and "here is a thing you can pay me to do." Everything after this — pricing, finding clients, proposals — depends on getting this part right first.

Key Terms

Term	Meaning
Service	A specific, packaged version of a skill that someone can hire you to do — it has a clear output, a clear audience, and clear limits.
Niche	A focused slice of a broader skill area — instead of "design," a niche might be "social media graphics for student clubs."
Scope	The boundaries of what's included in your service (and what isn't) — how much, how long, how many revisions.
Target client	The specific type of person or group your service is built for — not "everyone," but a named group you understand.

The Skill → Service Formula

SERVICE = SKILL + SPECIFIC OUTPUT + SPECIFIC AUDIENCE + SCOPE BOUNDARY

- **Skill** — something from your Course 16 portfolio you have real evidence of.
- **Specific output** — the actual thing the client receives (a website, a document, a set of graphics, a cleaned spreadsheet).
- **Specific audience** — who actually needs this and might realistically hire a teen for it (student clubs, tutors, small local groups, other students, family-adjacent contacts).
- **Scope boundary** — a limit: how many pages/items, how long it takes, or what's *not* included.

Worked Example: Jordan R.

Jordan's Course 16 portfolio includes three proven pieces: 1. A personal website built with HTML/CSS 2. A set of presentation slide designs made in Canva for a school debate team 3. A spreadsheet Jordan built to track and chart a class fundraiser's donations

Applying the formula to each:

Skill	Service Idea
HTML/CSS	"I build simple 3-page websites for school clubs, delivered in one week, with one round of revisions."
Canva slide design	"I design a matching 10-slide presentation deck for a student team's competition or pitch, turned around in 3 days."
Spreadsheet tracking	"I set up a spreadsheet that tracks and charts a club's fundraiser or event signups automatically, so organizers don't have to update it by hand."

Notice: each one names an output, an audience, and a limit. None of them say "I do design" or "I'm good with spreadsheets."

Step-by-Step Activity

You'll complete this in the **Skill-to-Service Builder Worksheet** (Notion or Google Docs — whichever your instructor assigned).

Step 1 — List your skills. Open your Course 16 portfolio. Pick 2–3 skills you have real, finished work to back up. Write them in the skills inventory table.

Step 2 — Draft 2–3 possible services. For each skill, use the formula to draft at least one possible service. Aim for 2–3 total service ideas across your skills. Don't worry about picking the "best" one yet — get options down first.

Step 3 — Pick your strongest one. Look at your options. Ask yourself: - Which one can I describe in one sentence without hesitating? - Which one is closest to something I could actually start doing soon? - Which one has the clearest audience — do I know where to even find these people?

Write your final choice into the "My Chosen Service" statement using the template in the worksheet.

Two Mistakes to Avoid

"My service has to work for everyone." Wrong. A service for "everyone" is actually a service for no one — it's too vague to say yes to. Naming a specific audience (a club, a type of student, a small local group) makes your service *easier* to sell, not smaller.

"My service has to be completely unique." Also wrong. Plenty of people build websites or design graphics. What makes a beginner service work isn't originality — it's being specific, reliable, and easy to understand. You can develop your own style over time; you don't need it to start.

Knowledge Checks

1. What are the three qualities a service needs that a skill alone doesn't have?
2. Fill in the blank: Service = Skill + ___ + **Specific Audience** + ____.
3. Why is "I design graphics for businesses" weaker than "I design a 5-template Instagram graphic set for student clubs"?
4. True or False: If another student already offers a similar service, you shouldn't offer yours. Explain your answer.
5. Give one reason a scope boundary (like "one round of revisions" or "3-page limit") actually helps you, the person offering the service.

Reflection Prompts

1. Which of your Course 16 skills surprised you by turning into a real service idea? Why?
2. Look at your final service statement — what's one specific audience member (a real club, group, or person type) who might actually need it?
3. What's one thing about your chosen service that still feels unclear or unfinished to you, and what would help you clarify it?

Submission Instructions

Before class ends (or by the deadline your instructor sets): 1. Complete all sections of your Skill-to-Service Builder Worksheet. 2. Make sure your final "My Chosen Service" statement includes a specific output, a specific audience, and a scope boundary. 3. Save your worksheet in your Lumexa portfolio/planning folder (Notion or Google Docs) — the same one holding your Course 16 work. 4. Share the document link with your instructor by end of class or via email if working asynchronously.

You'll need this service statement for the next lesson, where you start figuring out what to actually charge for it.